

Perspective Glasses Student Handout

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 25-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	25-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	perspective-glasses

Big idea: Perspective can limit and enrich knowledge.

Student-Facing Prompt

Inspect Perspective Glasses Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Perspective Glasses Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: Four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Perspective Glasses Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A classroom photo interpreted through safety, beauty, efficiency, and fairness lenses. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Perspective Glasses Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A perspective switch where students must defend a reading they did not choose. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Perspective can limit and enrich knowledge.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students
1	After inspecting Perspective Glasses Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?
2	Which exact detail from Perspective Glasses Stimulus A did you use as evidence?
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?
6	Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?

Ready-to-Use Examples

- Four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object.
- A classroom photo interpreted through safety, beauty, efficiency, and fairness lenses.
- A perspective switch where students must defend a reading they did not choose.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Activity Steps

1. Assign groups different perspectives: student, teacher, parent, university admissions officer, AI company, another student.
2. Each group lists what they know, what they care about and what evidence they would request.
3. Groups present their interpretation.
4. The class separates factual disagreement from value disagreement.

Observation and Evidence Record

Use this grid to keep observation, inference, evidence, and confidence separate.

What I noticed	What I inferred	Evidence	Confidence

TOK Debrief

- Knowledge question: Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?
- Are some perspectives more legitimate than others?
- Can objectivity include multiple perspectives?

Knowledge Questions

- Does perspective limit knowledge or enrich it?
- Are some perspectives more legitimate than others?
- Can objectivity include multiple perspectives?

Transfer Example

For example, run this activity with four role cards: scientist, artist, historian, and advertiser looking at one object. Have students commit to an initial claim, then reveal the change, hidden rule, alternative context, or comparison that makes the knowledge problem visible.

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...